

End-of-Lease Bond-Back Checklist — Northern Territory

Protect your money — most bond disputes are avoidable with the right documentation.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice.

Section 1 — Understand How Your Bond Works

- ☐ ☐ **Know the maximum bond is 4 weeks' rent.**
- ☐ ☐ **Understand where your bond is held.** A bond paid to a real estate agent must be placed in a specially designated trust account; a private landlord also holds it in trust, and you can request the bank name and account number.
- ☐ ☐ **Know landlords must provide a receipt** for bond paid by cheque, cash, or credit card (electronic bank transfer doesn't require one).
- ☐ ☐ **Know a private landlord who's away from the NT for more than 14 days must notify the relevant authority** — a genuinely NT-specific protection given the Territory's transient population patterns.
- ☐ ☐ **Understand bond is not a general maintenance fund** — it can only be claimed against for legitimate reasons like unpaid rent or damage beyond fair wear and tear.

Section 2 — Before You Move Out

- ☐ ☐ **Locate your original entry condition report** — your baseline for comparison.
- ☐ ☐ **Compare the property's current condition against that report**, room by room.
- ☐ ☐ **Clean thoroughly**, addressing anything genuinely beyond fair wear and tear.
- ☐ ☐ **Check every item on the original inventory** is present and in working order.
- ☐ ☐ **Settle any outstanding rent** before vacating.

Section 3 — At the Final Inspection

- ☐ ☐ **Attend the final inspection if you can**, comparing the property against the original condition report.
- ☐ ☐ **Take your own timestamped photos** of every room after cleaning, regardless of whether the agent attends.
- ☐ ☐ **Keep every receipt** — cleaning, repairs, pest control — as evidence.
- ☐ ☐ **Know the landlord cannot charge you for reasonable wear and tear.**

Section 4 — Claiming Your Bond

- ☐ ☐ **Lodge your side of the bond claim** once you've vacated.
- ☐ ☐ **If both parties agree**, the bond is released according to the agreed split.
- ☐ ☐ **If there's a dispute**, either party can apply to the **Northern Territory Civil and Administrative Tribunal (NTCAT)** for resolution.

Section 5 — If There's a Dispute

- ☐ ☐ **Gather your evidence before applying to NTCAT**: entry and exit condition reports, timestamped photos, receipts, and correspondence.
- ☐ ☐ **Apply to NTCAT** if you and your landlord can't agree — the Tribunal will review evidence from both sides and make a binding decision under the Residential Tenancies Act 1999.
- ☐ ☐ **Know landlords generally have limited time to escalate rent arrears matters** — if rent is more than 14 days overdue, the landlord can issue a 7-day notice; if unpaid after that, they may then apply to NTCAT.

Quick Reference — NT Bond Process

ITEM	DETAIL
Maximum bond	4 weeks' rent
Bond held in	A designated trust account (agent) or by the landlord in trust
Dispute resolution	NTCAT (Northern Territory Civil and Administrative Tribunal)
Fair wear and tear	Cannot be charged against your bond

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